



Samsung reinvents the 'toilet'

Samsung said that it has developed a prototype toilet for the world's poorest communities.
<https://digit.in/sep22-35>



iMessage like DPs on WhatsApp

WhatsApp is likely planning to bring iMessage-like profile photos within group chats.
<https://digit.in/sep22-36>

Composer and music producer Ishaan Chhabra is open to any kind of reinterpretation as long as it is done the right way and respectfully. "The original song exudes its own keys and tempo that the composer had in mind while scoring it. So, it's pointless to randomly distort the true essence of one's creation. For instance, A.R. Rahmansaab's 'Rehna Tu' from Delhi 6 already has a brilliant arrangement. So there was no need for an alternate one," he objects.

"Misrepresentation of myriad Bollywood songs doesn't really do justice to their actual flavor. Like melodies have an in-built ear-pleasing sweetness and a calming effect. There's no reason why unnecessary elements should tamper with the genre," he cautions. Having said that, Chhabra confesses to have heard some really great reboots of the past releases. "Personally, it's always interesting to lend an ear to a new spin to the older versions that I've loved and grown up listening to," he concedes.

Similar sentiment is echoed by singer-songwriter Aanchal Srivastva. "I love what sounds nice! Even if it is a lo-fi mix, I've no qualms with it. See, every style has its potential and audience, and thus it becomes a mad craze," she adds. Coming to the criticism against transforming the vocalist's tonal quality with a heavy and bold texture, Aanchal rests all speculations. "It is not always a thumbs-down case after all! 'Jhoom's' lo-fi version is simply great with the character of the original voice intact in it," she reminds.

With music having become more technologically driven now, even normal notes are given a metallic, hip-hop twist. When asked if she subscribes to this approach, she gleefully adds with a cackle that "I always welcome a new perspective and isn't that every first will have its initial hiccups?"

Reworked songs are no longer a novelty factor in Bollywood music circuit and are often dismissed as trash. So, will lo-fi continue its momentum with its unplugged, analog recording like quality? "As long as it

can make people skip a beat, it is here to stay, no matter how unmastered it may occasionally sound. Look, music producers are smart enough to know that the shelf-life of every genre is short-lived today. Today's audience is susceptible to varied options with its widespread exposure to the vast repertoire of world music. Hence, this too shall pass as a phase and drift into another genre seamlessly," she thinks.

Regarding her take on ceaseless mashups of chart-toppers with different singers chipping in, she affirms that she finds the move to be "absolutely cool". She praises the punch of freshness that mashups and new voices bring to the songs.

Vox Populi on Lo-Fi

Although singer-composer Ujjwal Kashyap appreciates the vibe of lo-fi, slowing down the original composition in the existing tracks doesn't really go down well with him. "It kills the soul in some songs," he complains, conveying his selective inclination for the lo-fi fad. Whether tweaking the rendition style and shifting the pitch add any qualitative value or a different dimension, to that, Kashyap bluntly remarks that "Lo-fi at times takes away the original zone."

He is not so fond of music with high-on-technology base. "I like the idea of mixing organic instruments with electronica. Music with hi-tech quality dies down after a point. It lacks eternal appeal," he states.

Remixes have always drawn a lot of flak as mindless output for allegedly spoiling the original pattern of the songs. On this front, he comments: "Lo-fi might work only if the makers keep the richness of the original numbers untouched. They may enhance the orchestration but certainly spare the vocals."

As far as mashups are concerned, he dubs the same great if played in an agreeable ambience. "It definitely gives a continuous kind of effect like a running stream to its listeners who do enjoy such genres off and on," he signs off.

of their homes. So, if your mood is ever off, find some solace or a perfect confidante in lo-fi. It scans the prevailing condition of your mind and marries it with music in absolute harmony as if bearing its reflection ditto like a mirror. No wonder then that zillions of netizens are increasingly skimming the lo-fi music directory on a daily basis.

Will lo-fi turn out to be a flash in the pan or have permanent appeal, only time will tell. But you in the meantime, may drown yourself in the ocean of Lo-fi love even in the wee hours. A WhatsApp notification broke into Meghna's solitude. The message reads: *Returning soon. The wait has been long but not endless and it's never going to be fruitless either.* ☺ I promise!

The sender's DP brings back that sunny smile on her face, which Manav always craves. The doleful silence now creeps into a ray of rejoice. Arijit's passionate voice now assumes a low-pitched baritone with poise, crooning: *Shayad kabhi na keh sakoon main tumko/ Kabe bina samajh lo tum shayad....* the notes float around in the air and the lady-love dreams away! 📺